



NEW ZEALAND RELOCATION GUIDE

Written by
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NAU MAI HAERE MAI/ WELCOME

Kia Ora,

Congratulations on taking your first step towards a new life in Aotearoa New Zealand.

This pack is designed to help you navigate the ins and outs of moving to New Zealand, offering valuable information on immigration procedures, housing, healthcare, local culture, and more. Whether you're relocating with your family or by yourself, we want to ensure your transition to New Zealand is as smooth and enjoyable as possible, allowing you to embrace the opportunities and experiences this beautiful country has to offer.

We hope you find the information helpful, and we wish you and your whanau (family) every success for the future. Let your “Kiwi” adventure begin!

Nga Mihi Nui,

Sophie, CEO, Ethicare Resourcing & the Ethicare Team



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ABOUT NEW ZEALAND

Location

New Zealand is located in the southwestern Pacific Ocean, approximately 1,200 miles (1,900 kilometres) southeast of Australia. It consists of two main land masses, the North Island and the South Island, as well as several smaller islands.

The country is situated in Oceania, the smallest continent in the world, also known as Australasia

Geography

New Zealand's geography is a captivating blend of natural wonders. From the towering peaks of the Southern Alps and the geothermal marvels of the North Island to the tranquil beauty of its lakes, beaches, and fiords, the country offers an astonishing array of landscapes. These diverse terrains have sculpted a playground for outdoor enthusiasts and a haven for those who appreciate nature's splendour. Whether you're drawn to the snow-capped mountains or the pristine coastlines, New Zealand's geography ensures that every corner of the country is a visual masterpiece waiting to be explored.



New Zealand climate

New Zealand experiences a diverse range of climates due to its unique geography, which spans from north to south and encompasses mountains, plains, and coastal areas. The country's climate can be broadly categorized into four main types:

Subtropical: The northern regions of New Zealand, particularly the Northland and Auckland areas, have a subtropical climate. Summers are warm and humid, while winters are mild, with temperatures rarely dropping below freezing. These regions receive more rainfall throughout the year, and occasional tropical cyclones can affect the area.



Temperate: Most of the North Island and parts of the northern South Island have a temperate climate. This means warm, dry summers and cooler, wetter winters. Cities like Wellington fall into this category, with comfortable year-round temperatures.

Continental: The central South Island, including areas like Canterbury and Otago, has a continental climate characterized by hot, dry summers and cold winters with regular frost and occasional snowfall.

Alpine: The Southern Alps, which run through the South Island, have an alpine climate. This means colder temperatures year-round, with heavy snowfall in the winter, making it a popular destination for winter sports enthusiasts.



Mount Cook National Park

Average weather

The average New Zealand temperature decreases as you travel south. January and February are the warmest months, and July is the coldest month of the year.



Spring

Sept-Nov

Average daytime
temperature

16-19 degrees



Summer

Dec-Feb

Average daytime
temperature

20-25 degrees



Autumn

Mar-May

Average daytime
temperature

17-21 degrees



Winter

Jun-Aug

Average daytime
temperature

12-16 degrees

People

The people of New Zealand, affectionately known as Kiwis, embody a unique blend of warmth, inclusivity, and a love for the great outdoors. They are renowned for their friendliness, making visitors feel right at home with their open and welcoming nature.

Kiwis have a relaxed and easy-going attitude, prioritizing work-life balance and relishing the abundant natural beauty that surrounds them. Their appreciation for the environment also shines through in their efforts to protect and preserve the country's natural heritage, making New Zealand a nation that values both its people and the planet.



Kiwi family enjoying a picnic

Culture

New Zealand's culture is a dynamic tapestry that weaves together Māori heritage and European influences in a unique and harmonious way.

The Māori, New Zealand's indigenous people, have a profound impact on the nation's culture, with their language, customs, and art playing a significant role in daily life. The traditional Māori greeting, or hongi, symbolizes the respect and unity that underpin the culture.

New Zealand's European heritage, primarily from British settlers, has added layers of tradition, values, and institutions. The country's cultural diversity continues to expand with the influence of Pacific and Asian communities, creating a rich mosaic of culinary delights and festivals.

This fusion of indigenous, European, and global elements results in a **welcoming, inclusive culture that cherishes both tradition and progress, making New Zealand an enriching and vibrant place to live.**



Māori make up over 14 percent of the population. Their language and culture has a major impact on all facets of New Zealand life.

The Hongi, a traditional Māori greeting

Language

The main languages in New Zealand are Māori, English and New Zealand sign language.

The Treaty of Waitangi

The Treaty of Waitangi was signed in 1840 and was an agreement between the British Crown and a large number of Māori chiefs. The key points of the Treaty of Waitangi can be summarized as follows:

1. **Protection of Māori Rights:** The treaty aimed to protect the rights and property of the Māori people.
2. **Ceding Sovereignty:** The Māori version of the treaty ceded governance to the British Crown, while the English version assured the Māori of their continued authority over their lands, forests, and fisheries.
3. **Equality and Citizenship:** The treaty promised Māori the same rights as British citizens.
4. **Mutual Respect and Cooperation:** It emphasized a partnership and cooperation between the British and Māori.

Today the Te Tiriti o Waitangi (the Treaty of Waitangi) is widely accepted as a constitutional document that establishes and guides the relationship between the Crown in New Zealand (embodied by the government) and Māori.



Treaty of Waitangi in art

The "Tiaki Promise"

The "Tiaki Promise" is an initiative in New Zealand that aims to educate both residents and visitors about the importance of being responsible and respectful to the country's natural beauty and cultural treasures. The word "Tiaki" means "to care for" in the Māori language, and the Tiaki Promise is a commitment to protect and preserve New Zealand's natural environment, culture, and heritage.

The Tiaki Promise includes a set of guiding principles, such as showing respect to the land, sea, and nature; traveling safely and responsibly; respecting cultural differences and traditions; and being mindful of the environment and its conservation. It emphasizes the importance of taking care of New Zealand's pristine landscapes for future generations.



Politics and government

New Zealand's government operates as a parliamentary democracy under a constitutional monarchy. It follows a system of government heavily influenced by the British model. The country's Head of State is the British monarch, represented by the Governor-General of New Zealand. **The country's political culture emphasizes human rights, the rule of law, and a strong commitment to environmental sustainability,** contributing to its reputation for stable and progressive governance.



The Beehive, home to NZ's Parliament

10 Things you (probably) didn't know about New Zealand

1. **Unique Biodiversity:** New Zealand is home to a remarkable array of flora and fauna, much of which is found nowhere else in the world. This includes the kiwi bird, which is not only a national symbol but also a flightless and nocturnal bird native to New Zealand.
2. **Maori Culture:** The indigenous Maori people have a rich cultural heritage. The haka, a traditional Maori dance, is well-known worldwide, often performed by the national rugby team before matches.
3. **Geothermal Wonders:** The country sits on the Pacific Ring of Fire, resulting in geothermal activity. Rotorua, for example, is known for its geysers, hot springs, and bubbling mud pools. .
4. **Adventure Capital of the World:** Queenstown is often referred to as the adventure capital of the world. It's a hub for various outdoor activities, including bungee jumping, skydiving, skiing, and water sports,
5. **First Country to Grant Women the Right to Vote:** New Zealand has a progressive history & and was the first self-governing country in the world to grant women the right to vote in 1893.
6. **No Snakes:** One interesting fact for those with ophidiophobia (fear of snakes) is that New Zealand is one of the few countries in the world where there are no native snake species.
7. **Film Locations:** The breathtaking landscapes of New Zealand have served as the backdrop for many famous movies, including the "Lord of the Rings" & "The Hobbit" trilogies directed by Peter Jackson.
8. **Southern Hemisphere Stargazing:** New Zealand, especially in the South Island, offers some of the best stargazing opportunities in the Southern Hemisphere. The Aoraki Mackenzie International Dark Sky Reserve is one of the best places to observe the night sky.
9. **Longest Place Name:** New Zealand is home to one of the longest place names in the world:
Taumatawhakatangihangakoauauotamateaturipukakapikimaungahoronukupokaiwhenuakitanatahu. It is a hill in the Hawke's Bay region.
10. **No Snails or Frogs:** As well as having no native snake, New Zealand also lacks native land mammals (except for bats), & until human arrival, it had no land-based reptiles. It also doesn't have land snails or frogs

PREPARING FOR YOUR MOVE

Applying for a visa

Immigration New Zealand has a very comprehensive website to support applicants with selecting and applying for the correct work visa. Te Whatu Ora also provides a free immigration service run by qualified immigration advisors. Further information can be found here: <https://www.tewhatauora.govt.nz/whats-happening/work-underway/international-recruitment-centre/>



Shipping belongings

Te Whatu Ora supports candidates with the costs of shipping essential items from their country of origin to New Zealand. There are several international removal companies depending on where in the world you are coming from. You should get quotes from at least two companies before making a decision. Te Whatu Ora will require a copy of the invoice which must be no more than the amount stated in your bond agreement (refer to your job offer).

Temporary accommodation

All new employees relocating from overseas will be offered a temporary accommodation package. Te Whatu Ora will provide support in finding suitable accommodation on a case by case basis to meet yours/and your families needs.

Relocating to New Zealand with children

Relocating to New Zealand with children can be an incredibly exciting time. With its high standard of education, low crime rates, clean air and focus on sports and outdoor living, New Zealand ticks all the boxes when it comes to finding the perfect place to raise a family.

In this section, you will find everything you need, to prepare your little one's for their new adventure.

New Zealand provides children with the space and freedom: to ride horses, to run along open beaches, to swim in clean water, to walk through native forests and to experience the beauty of nature.

Tips to help prepare children for the move

1. Communication:

Start early and have open, age-appropriate conversations with your children about the move. Encourage them to express their feelings and ask questions



2. Listen and Validate

Listen to your children's concerns and feelings. Validate their emotions and reassure them that it's okay to feel a range of emotions, including excitement and anxiety.

3. Pack Together:

Involve your children in the packing process. Let them choose a few items to bring with them that hold sentimental value.

4 Maintain Routine:

Keep a sense of routine as much as possible. Consistency in daily schedules can provide stability and comfort during a time of change.

5. Research Together:

Research the new country and its culture as a family. Learn about its customs, traditions, and local attractions. This can make the move feel like an exciting adventure.

6. Say Goodbyes:

Encourage your children to say goodbye to friends, teachers, and family members. Host a farewell party or gathering to make it a positive and memorable experience.

7. Stay Positive:

Maintain a positive attitude about the move, emphasizing the opportunities and exciting aspects of the new country.

8. Explore Cultural Differences:

Learn about cultural differences, customs, and traditions in the new country. This can be an exciting part of the experience.

9. Connect with Other Expats:

Connect with expat communities in the new country. Your children may find comfort in meeting other kids who have experienced similar moves.

10. Pack a Comfort Kit:

Allow your children to pack a comfort kit with their favourite toys, books, or other items from their current home.

11. Stay Patient and Flexible:

Be prepared for an adjustment period. Understand that children may have moments of homesickness, frustration, or anxiety, and that's normal.



Tips for flying with kids

Flying with kids can be a rewarding but challenging experience. Here are our top ten tips to help make your flight with kids more manageable and enjoyable:

1. Plan and Book in Advance:

Book your flights early to secure seating arrangements that work for your family.

Plan flights during times that align with your child's schedule, such as naptime or bedtime.

2. Prepare for Security Checkpoints:

Be organized and informed about the security screening process, including rules for carrying baby items and child supplies through security.

3. Pack Smart:

Pack a well-organized carry-on bag with essentials like diapers, wipes, a change of clothes, snacks, and entertainment items.

Consider using a backpack for easy access to items during the flight.

4 Entertainment and Distractions:

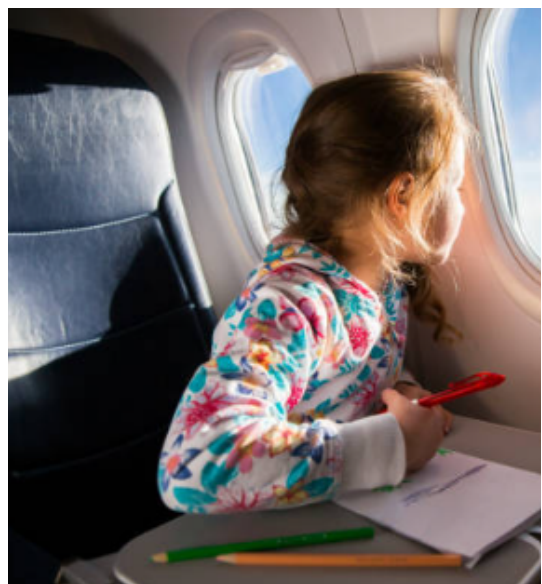
Bring a variety of entertainment, such as books, colouring books, toys, and electronic devices.

Download kid-friendly apps, movies, or games on tablets or smartphones.

5. Child-Friendly Seating:

Choose seating that works best for your family, such as bulkhead seats or a row with an empty middle seat.

Consider using child restraint devices, like CARES harnesses or approved car seats.



6. Bring Comfort Items:

Pack your child's favourite comfort items, such as a blanket, stuffed animal, or pacifier.

7. Snacks and Hydration:

Pack a variety of snacks that your child enjoys and stay hydrated during the flight.

Avoid sugary treats that can lead to energy spikes and crashes.



8. Prepare for Ear Pressure Changes:

For take-off and landing, offer a bottle or pacifier, or encourage swallowing to help relieve ear pressure for infants and young children.

Set Expectations and Rules:

9. Communicate with your child about what to expect during the flight and establish basic rules for behaviour.

Encourage good manners and respect for other passengers.

Stay Calm and Patient:

10. Maintain a positive attitude and stay patient. Kids can pick up on your emotions, so model calm behaviour.

Be prepared for the unexpected and take delays or in-flight challenges in stride.

Relocating pets

We understand that for many, pets are an important part of the family, and will join you on your journey to Aotearoa, New Zealand.

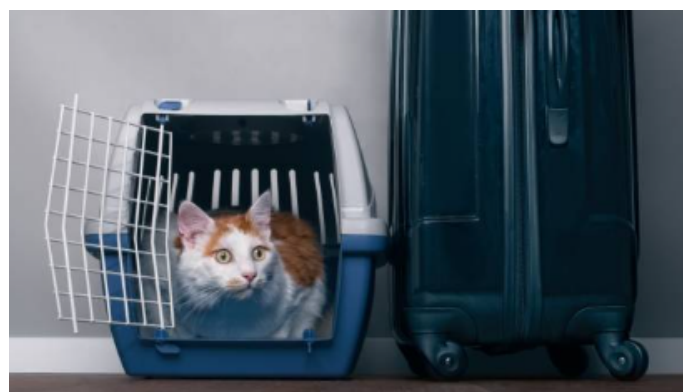
We recommend starting the process well in advance, as the timeline for compliance with regulations can be quite lengthy. Engaging with a professional pet relocation service or consulting with the MPI in New Zealand can help ensure a smooth and successful transition for your pets to their new home.



Here are some key steps to consider when relocating pets to New Zealand:

- **Check Eligibility:** Ensure your pet is eligible for importation into New Zealand. Certain dog breeds, such as American Pit Bull Terriers, Brazilian Fila, and Dogo Argentino, are prohibited.
- **Microchipping:** All cats and dogs must be microchipped for identification purposes. Make sure the microchip meets ISO standards.
- **Rabies Vaccination:** Ensure your pet has up-to-date rabies vaccinations. These should be administered at least six months before travelling to New Zealand.
- **Blood Tests:** Cats and dogs must have a rabies serology test to confirm that the vaccination is effective. This should be done at an approved laboratory.
- **Internal and External Parasite Treatment:** Treat your pet for internal and external parasites, including tapeworms and ticks. These treatments should be administered within a specified timeframe before travelling.

- **Import Permit:** Apply for an import permit from the Ministry for Primary Industries (MPI) in New Zealand. This is usually done several weeks before travel.
- **Quarantine:** Pets must undergo a minimum of ten days of quarantine upon arrival in New Zealand. The quarantine facility should be pre-arranged and booked well in advance. There are four quarantine facilities in New Zealand. More information on each facility can be found by clicking the following link: <https://www.mpi.govt.nz/bring-send-to-nz/pets-travelling-to-nz/bringing-cats-and-dogs-to-nz/quarantine-facilities-and-importing-cats-and-dogs/>
- **Transportation:** Choose a reputable pet transport company with experience in relocating animals to New Zealand. They will help with flight arrangements, proper documentation, and meeting biosecurity requirements.
- **Health Certificates:** Obtain an official veterinary health certificate for your pet issued shortly before departure. This certificate should confirm the pet's health and compliance with New Zealand's import regulations.
- **Pet Food and Toys:** Ensure you follow New Zealand's regulations regarding bringing in pet food and toys, as some items may be subject to inspection and treatment.
- **Costs:** Relocating pets to New Zealand can be expensive due to transportation, quarantine, and various health and compliance requirements. Be prepared for these costs.
- **Cats and Dogs Act:** Familiarize yourself with New Zealand's Cats and Dogs Act, which imposes certain responsibilities on pet owners in New Zealand.



FINANCE, TAX AND EMPLOYMENT

Setting up a bank account

You can open a bank account in NZ before you travel but will need to visit a branch to activate it once you arrive. You need a visa that allows you to stay in the country such as a work, residence, or student visa.

You may wish to provide the NZ bank with a reference letter from your current bank which includes a credit score or rating. Your employer can provide you with a letter of a confirmed work address to speed up the process.

Electronic Funds Transfer at Point of Sale (EFTPOS) is a way to use funds from your bank account when shopping.

To open a bank account you will need the following:

- An identity document – Current valid passport or national ID card
- Proof of address – this can be your current overseas address but will need to provide a permanent address in NZ
- A NZ IRD (Internal Revenue Department) number – if you don't have one yet, you can use your tax number or tax declaration from your country of origin
- Proof of your visa

The main banks in New Zealand are; Kiwi Bank, Westpac, Bank of New Zealand, ASB, and ANZ.



Getting paid

All Te Whatu employees are paid fortnightly by direct credit into their nominated bank account

Tax in New Zealand

In New Zealand, all personal income is taxed. You will need to pay income tax on all income you receive from New Zealand and overseas.

Taxes are the primary source of revenue for New Zealand's Government and it is predominately spent on infrastructure, public services and welfare. The links below provide more information about tax in New Zealand.

<https://www.live-work.immigration.govt.nz/live-in-new-ealand/money-tax/taxes>

<https://www.ird.govt.nz/index/calculators-and-tools>

Getting an IRD number

To register to pay tax in New Zealand, you need to apply for an IRD number. Without this, you will not be able to receive any salary payments.

The easiest and fastest way for you to obtain an IRD tax number is to apply to the AA. The AA has been appointed by the Inland Revenue to accept individual IRD number applications.

You can apply in person at an AA Driver Licensing Agent. You can fill out the application form and bring the required documents to your local agent. Our staff will submit your application to Inland Revenue. The AA has close to 100 licensing agents around New Zealand.

You can apply online through the Inland Revenue website. Please note that you will still need to come to an AA Driver Licensing Agent with the required identification documents to have them verified within 60 days of your online application.

How much does it cost?

The express service costs \$10 and guarantees that you get an IRD number within 4 working days. If you do not pay the express fee, it takes approximately 3 weeks for your IRD number to come through.

You will need to present each of these documents to the AA (along with legible copies) of:

- A current valid passport
- A NZ bank statement or printout showing the customer's name, bank account number and at least one deposit and one withdrawal of differing amounts OR a letter from your bank showing your customer's name, and bank account number.
- Proof of your address, for example, a letter or bill from your utility company or, if you do not have a permanent address yet, you can ask your District to provide a support letter stating you are a new arrival to New Zealand, the address you are currently staying at, and that you are in the process of finding long term accommodation.
- Copy of your employment contract
- Copy of your valid NZ work or residence visa

Links to the Inland Revenue and the AA can be found below

<https://www.aa.co.nz/about/identity-verification/ird/>

<https://www.ird.govt.nz/managing-my-tax/ird-numbers/ird-numbers-for-individuals/new-arrival-to-new-zealand---ird-number-application>

KiwiSaver

KiwiSaver is New Zealand's savings scheme which is administered by the Government to help people save for their retirement. Te Whatu Ora will make deductions to the IRD who pass your contribution to the KiwiSaver provider. Please note until you are a New Zealand resident you are not eligible for the KiwiSaver scheme.



Insurance

Moving to a new country is exciting, but don't forget the basics. We recommend that you consider taking out insurance policies to prepare for the unexpected. Further information on insurance for migrants, can be found in the link below.

<https://www.live-work.immigration.govt.nz/resources/insurance-in-new-zealand-a-guide-for-migrants>

ACC

Accident Compensation Corporation (ACC) is Aotearoa New Zealand's accident compensation scheme. It provides no-fault personal injury insurance cover to all New Zealand residents, and visitors to New Zealand. ACC is funded by the government and NZ public.

Finding employment

If your partner or family member is looking for job opportunities in New Zealand, there are several reputable job search websites where you can find employment listings. Here are some of the best job sites in New Zealand:

Kiwi Health Jobs: Kiwi Health Jobs is the main site for vacancies across Te Whatu Ora and the healthcare, private sector

Website: <https://www.kiwihealthjobs.com/>

Trade Me Jobs: Trade Me is a popular online marketplace in New Zealand, and their job listings cover a wide range of industries and job types.

Website:

Seek: Seek is one of the largest and most well-known job search websites in New Zealand, offering a wide variety of job listings.

Website:

Jora: Jora is a job search engine that aggregates job listings from various sources, making it easy to find job opportunities in New Zealand.

Website:

Work and Income New Zealand (WINZ): The government-operated WINZ website provides job listings, career advice, and information about financial support for job seekers.

Website: <https://www.workandincome.govt.nz/>

MyJobSpace: MyJobSpace is a New Zealand-focused job portal offering a wide range of job listings and career resources.

Website: <https://jobspace.co.nz/>

Seek Volunteer: If you're interested in volunteer work, Seek Volunteer lists a variety of volunteer opportunities across New Zealand.

Website: <https://seekvolunteer.co.nz/>

New Kiwis: New Kiwis is a platform designed to help migrants find job opportunities in New Zealand. It offers job listings and resources for newcomers.

Website: <https://www.chamberemployment.co.nz/migrants>

Indeed: While Indeed is a global job search engine, it has a New Zealand-specific website with a significant number of job listings.

Website: <https://nz.indeed.com/>

Careerjet: Careerjet is another job search engine that aggregates job listings from various sources, making it easy to search for jobs in New Zealand.

Website: <https://www.careerjet.co.nz/>

LIFE IN NEW ZEALAND

New Zealand offers a diverse array of lifestyles, ranging from the bustling urban environments of Auckland and Wellington to the peaceful serenity of remote rural areas. With a robust economy, political stability, and a dedicated focus on environmental sustainability, it's no surprise that New Zealand consistently earns its place among the world's top destinations for quality living.

Housing

Having a place to call home plays a significant role in establishing a sense of belonging in a new country, and the process of finding the perfect home for you and your family may require some time and consideration. We believe it's advisable to start by renting, even if your ultimate goal is to purchase a property. Renting allows you the opportunity to explore the available housing options and decide where you'd like to settle before making a long-term commitment.



Whether you desire an outdoor-oriented lifestyle, a central city residence, or a spacious family home with room for your children to play, New Zealand offers a range of choices.

Renting a property

If you are renting you will need to sign an agreement with the landlord and pay a bond for up to four weeks rent in advance. The bond is lodged with the government's Tenancy Services. When you leave the rental property you will receive your bond back minus any damage's costs or unpaid rent. Most rentals are unfurnished however furniture and whiteware can be rented in most parts of the country and either the landlord or property manager can give advice on where to obtain these.

Finding a property

We recommend the following websites, to help find a suitable rental property for you and your family.

Trademe - <https://www.trademe.co.nz/a/property/residential>

Bayleys - <https://www.bayleys.co.nz/>

Harcourts - <https://harcourts.net/nz>

Ray White - <https://raywhite.co.nz/>



Rental Prices

Rental costs in New Zealand can vary widely depending on factors like location, property type, and local demand. Here's a general overview:

Major City - Auckland:

Flat Share: Shared accommodations: NZD 200 - 400+ per week

1-Bedroom Apartment: Central Business District (CBD): NZD 400 - 700+ pw
Suburbs: NZD 300 - 550+ per week.

3-Bedroom House: Detached houses in desirable areas: 600 - 1,200+ pw

Small City - Rotorua:

Flat Share: Shared accommodations or flat share: NZD 150 - 300+ per week.

1-Bedroom Apartment: Rotorua CBD: NZD 250 - 450+ per week.

3-Bedroom House: Detached houses in various areas: NZD 400 - 800+ pw

Small Town - Matamata (Near Hobbiton):

Flat Share: Shared accommodations or flat share in small towns: 100-250+ pw

1-Bedroom Apartment: Limited availability; prices vary widely. 200-400 pw

3-Bedroom House: In small towns, rental costs can vary. NZD 300 - 600+ pw

Village - Example: Akaroa (Banks Peninsula):

Flat Share: Shared accommodations or flat share in a village: 100 - 200+ pw

1-Bedroom Apartment: Limited availability; prices range from 150 - 350+ pw

3-Bedroom House: In villages, rental costs can vary widely. NZD 250 - 500+ pw

Rural Area - Example: Waimate (South Canterbury):

Flat Share: Shared accommodations or flat share in rural areas: 80 - 150+ pw

1-Bedroom Apartment: Limited availability; prices vary widely. 150 - 300+ pw

3-Bedroom House: In rural areas rental costs vary significantly. 200 -400+ pw

Remember that these are general estimates, and actual prices can vary. It's advisable to conduct thorough research or consult with local real estate professionals for the most accurate and current information.

Utility bills

Accessing services like electricity and an internet connection may be a bit different to what you are used to. We recommend that you visit New Zealand's immigration website and Compare Bear (a utility comparison website) for all the information you need to get set up with utility essentials. A link to the sites can be found below.

<https://www.live-work.immigration.govt.nz/live-in-new-zealand/housing/utilities>

<https://www.comparebear.co.nz/set-up-utilities-in-your-new-home>



Coromandel Beach



Beach near Dunedin

Driving in New Zealand

If you have a valid overseas driver licence, you can convert it to a NZ driver licence. A valid licence means that your licence is not suspended, disqualified or revoked in the country of issue and must either be current or expired within the last 12 months.

You can only drive using an overseas licence for 12 months from your last date of entry into Aotearoa. If you've been in Aotearoa for more than 12 months, you won't be able to drive on your overseas driver licence anymore. You must have a NZ licence.

You will need evidence of your identity, proof that your eyesight meets the required standard, provide a medical certificate if required, present your overseas driver licence and a translation if not in English, let the agent take your photo and signature, pay the application fee, provide high-quality colour photocopies of all original documents you have provided.

Note that you will need to present your physical overseas driver licence.

Waka Kotahi (NZ Transport Agency) provides advice on motor registration, buying a car, car licensing, and change of ownership and warrant of fitness for cars.



Mount Cook National Park

New Zealand's healthcare system

New Zealand's healthcare system is generally regarded as good and is accessible to all residents and citizens, regardless of their income or socioeconomic status. **Publicly funded healthcare is also available to healthcare visa holders and their immediate family members.**



Further information about healthcare for Migrants in Aotearoa, New Zealand can be found in the link below.

<https://www.new-zealand-immigration.com/blogs/healthcare-for-immigrants-in-new-zealand>

Dentalcare

All children/adolescents up to the age of 18 get fully funded dental care across Aotearoa. Further information about visiting a Dentist and finding a Dentist in New Zealand can be found in the links below.

<https://www.health.govt.nz/your-health/services-and-support/health-care-services/visiting-dentist>

<https://www.nzda.org.nz/public/find-a-dentist>

Information about local healthcare providers

Healthpoint provides up-to-date information about healthcare providers, referral expectations, services offered and common treatments. We recommend that you use this website when researching healthcare providers in your local area once you are in New Zealand.

<https://www.healthpoint.co.nz/>

Education

The education system in New Zealand is known for its high quality and is considered to be one of the best in the world. It is structured in a way that provides a range of options for students at various levels and caters to a diverse range of learning styles and abilities. Below you will find an overview of the key aspects of the New Zealand education system.

Compulsory Education: Education in New Zealand is compulsory for children aged 6 to 16 years. Most students attend primary and secondary schools during this period.

Early Childhood Education (ECE): New Zealand places a strong emphasis on early childhood education. ECE is available for children from birth to the age of 5 and is not compulsory. It includes a range of options, such as kindergartens, play centres, home-based care, and childcare centers.

Primary and Secondary Education: The New Zealand education system is divided into primary, intermediate, and secondary schools. Primary school covers Year 1 to Year 8, intermediate covers Year 7 and Year 8, and secondary school covers Year 9 to Year 13. Students typically complete their NCEA (National Certificate of Educational Achievement) during these years.

National Curriculum:

New Zealand has a national curriculum that sets out what students are expected to learn at each level of education. The curriculum is designed to provide a broad and balanced education and includes subjects like English, mathematics, science, social studies, physical education, and the arts.



Tertiary Education: New Zealand offers a range of tertiary education options, including universities, polytechnics, and institutes of technology. There are eight government-funded universities in the country, offering undergraduate and postgraduate degrees. Polytechnics and institutes of technology focus on vocational and applied learning.

Schooling in Māori and English: New Zealand recognizes both Māori and English as official languages. Māori culture and language are an integral part of the New Zealand education system, and many schools offer bilingual education programs.

Special Education: New Zealand has provisions for students with special educational needs. Schools provide support and accommodations for students with disabilities, and there are special education schools and services available.

School Governance: Schools in New Zealand have boards of trustees made up of elected parent and community representatives. These boards have significant autonomy in managing school resources and making decisions.

School Fees and Funding: Public education in New Zealand is mostly funded by the government, and it is free at the primary and secondary levels. However, parents may be asked to make a voluntary donation to support the school. Tertiary education typically involves tuition fees, although there are scholarships and financial aid options available.

How do I enrol my child in a school in New Zealand?

Everything you need to enrol your child in a school of your choice can be found in the link below.

<https://parents.education.govt.nz/>

New Zealand School Term Dates

In New Zealand, the school year is divided into four terms. The exact dates for each term can vary slightly from year to year, but generally, they follow a similar pattern

Term 1

Typically starts in late January or early February and runs until mid-April. This term includes a break for Easter, which can fall in late March or early April.

Term 2:

Usually begins in late April or early May and continues until early July. There is typically a two-week break in late May or early June, known as the mid-term break or school holidays.

Term 3:

Starts in mid-July and runs until late September or early October. There may be a one-week break in mid-August, depending on the school's schedule.

Term 4:

Begins in mid-October and continues until mid-December. This term includes a six-week summer break, starting in mid-December and ending in late January or early February, marking the end of one school year and the start of the next.

It's important to note that these dates are a general guide, and schools may have variations in their term dates or additional holiday periods, such as teacher-only days or local holidays.

Below are some websites you may find useful in helping you find the right choice for your child. Remember, our relocation team is also on hand to share our knowledge and guidance.

<https://www.education.govt.nz>

Ministry of Education - Education in New Zealand: Delve into New Zealand's education system, accessing resources for parents and guidelines on school selection.

<https://www.education.govt.nz>

Education Counts: Find comprehensive statistics and insights about Wellington schools, including performance data.

<https://www.educationcounts.govt.nz>

NZQA (New Zealand Qualifications Authority): Understand the qualifications secondary schools in Wellington offer, with guides and information from NZQA.

<https://www.nzqa.govt.nz>

ERO (Education Review Office): ERO's reports on schools and early childhood services help assess educational quality, invaluable in your selection process.

<https://ero.govt.nz>

Independent Schools of New Zealand: For those considering private education, this site lists independent schools in Wellington, showcasing a diversity of educational philosophies.

<https://isnz.org.nz/>

NZ Association for Christian Schools: If a Christian education aligns with your family's values, explore a directory of Christian schools across Wellington and New Zealand.

<https://www.nzacs.nz/>

Catholic Education Office: Information on Catholic schools within the Wellington Archdiocese can be found here, highlighting their unique Catholic character and educational offerings.

<https://www.wn.catholic.org.nz/>

Religion in New Zealand

Religion in New Zealand is characterized by a diverse landscape of beliefs and practices. While Christianity, particularly Anglicanism and Presbyterianism, has traditionally been prominent, the country's religious landscape has evolved and today New Zealand is home to a variety of faiths, including Buddhism, Hinduism, Islam, and indigenous Māori spirituality. This diversity is a reflection of the country's commitment to religious freedom and tolerance, creating a welcoming environment for individuals from various religious backgrounds and those who identify as non-religious.



Masjid At Taqwa Mosque
Auckland

The following places of worship can be found in major urban areas across New Zealand.

- **Churches:** Christian churches are common throughout New Zealand, representing various denominations, including Anglican, Presbyterian, Catholic, Baptist, and others.
- **Temples:** Hindu, Sikh, and Buddhist temples can be found in cities with significant populations of people from these faiths.
- **Mosques:** New Zealand has mosques that serve the Muslim community, in all major cities.

- Synagogues: Jewish communities have synagogues in some cities, where they gather for worship and cultural events.
- Gurdwaras: Sikh places of worship, known as gurdwaras, can be found in areas with Sikh populations.
- Shrines and Temples: Some Māori communities maintain traditional meeting houses (wharehau) and sacred sites that serve as places of worship and cultural expression.
- Non-denominational and Spiritual Centers: New Zealand also has non-denominational and spiritual centres that cater to individuals who may have eclectic or non-traditional spiritual beliefs.

Cost of living

The cost of living in Aotearoa, New Zealand can vary significantly depending on the city and region, but it is generally considered relatively high. Major cities like Auckland and Wellington tend to have higher living expenses, particularly in terms of housing, which can be a significant portion of one's budget. However, it's worth noting that New Zealand offers a high quality of life, beautiful natural landscapes, and a strong social welfare system that includes public healthcare and education. Wages in New Zealand are also competitive, making it an attractive destination for expatriates and immigrants despite the higher cost of living.



More information on the cost of living can be found in the link below.
<https://www.live-work.immigration.govt.nz/live-in-new-zealand/money-tax/cost-of-living-in-new-zealand>

Grocery stores

In New Zealand, there are several supermarkets offering a variety of products at different price points. Here are some of the major supermarkets in Wellington along with a brief overview of their offerings and general price ranges:

Countdown: Countdown is one of the largest supermarket chains in New Zealand, offering a wide range of groceries, fresh produce, meat, dairy, and household items. Price Range: Countdown typically offers a mix of budget-friendly and premium products to cater to different customer preferences and budgets. Prices may vary depending on the specific products and promotions available.

New World: New World supermarkets are known for their focus on fresh produce, gourmet foods, and specialty items. They offer a wide selection of groceries, including organic and locally sourced products. Price Range: While New World tends to offer high-quality products, prices can vary depending on the brand and type of product. Some items may be more expensive compared to other supermarket chains due to their focus on specialty and premium goods.

FreshChoice: FreshChoice supermarkets offer a focus on fresh produce, quality meat, and a selection of specialty products. They provide a more upscale shopping experience compared to some other supermarket chains. Price Range: FreshChoice offers a mix of affordable and premium products, with prices varying depending on the quality and type of items. While some products may be priced higher, customers can expect a wider selection of gourmet and specialty goods.

Pak'nSave: Pak'nSave is a discount supermarket chain known for its low prices and bulk-buying options. They offer a no-frills shopping experience with a focus on value for money.

Price Range: Pak'nSave generally offers some of the lowest prices in the market, making it a popular choice for budget-conscious shoppers. While the selection may be more limited compared to other supermarkets, customers can find good deals on basic groceries and household essentials.

Moore Wilson's: Moore Wilson's is a specialty food and beverage retailer known for its extensive range of gourmet products, imported goods, and specialty ingredients. They also offer bulk-buying options for businesses and households.

Price Range: While Moore Wilson's may offer premium and specialty products at higher price points, customers can find unique and high-quality items that may not be available at other supermarkets.

Four Square: Four Square supermarkets are smaller neighborhood stores that offer convenience and a selection of essential groceries. They cater to local communities and provide a convenient shopping experience.

Price Range: Prices at Four Square may vary depending on the location and the range of products available. While they may not always offer the lowest prices, they provide convenience for shoppers in the area.

It's important to note that prices can vary depending on factors such as location, promotions, and seasonal availability. Additionally, shoppers may find differences in prices for specific products across different supermarket chains. It's advisable to compare prices and shop around to find the best deals based on individual preferences and needs.

Recreational activities

New Zealand offers a wide range of recreational activities thanks to its stunning natural landscapes and diverse terrain. Here are a few of our favourites!:

Hiking and Tramping: New Zealand is famous for its extensive network of hiking trails, ranging from easy walks to challenging multi-day treks. The Great Walks, such as the Milford Track and the Routeburn Track, are world-renowned for their scenic beauty.



Routeburn track

Mountain Biking: The country has a growing network of mountain biking trails, catering to riders of all skill levels. The Queenstown Bike Park and Rotorua's Whakarewarewa Forest are particularly popular destinations for mountain biking.

Skiing and Snowboarding: New Zealand offers excellent skiing and snowboarding opportunities in the Southern Alps, particularly in places like Queenstown, Wanaka, and the Mt. Ruapehu region.



Ski slope, Wanaka

Beach Time: New Zealand's beautiful beaches are a major attraction. Kiwis often spend their spare time at the beach, whether it's swimming, sunbathing, or playing beach sports.



Water Sports: New Zealand's extensive coastline and numerous lakes provide ample opportunities for water sports. You can go kayaking, white-water rafting, sailing, and even surfing. The beaches of Northland, the Coromandel Peninsula, and the Bay of Plenty are great for swimming and surfing.

Wildlife Viewing: New Zealand is home to unique wildlife, including the kiwi bird and the world's smallest dolphin, the Hector's dolphin. You can enjoy wildlife tours, birdwatching, and marine mammal encounters.



Whale watching Kaikoura

Wine Tours: New Zealand has a growing reputation for its wine, particularly its Sauvignon Blanc and Pinot Noir. Explore the various wine regions, such as Marlborough and Central Otago, on guided wine tours.



Winery, Marlborough, Central
Otago

Arts and Culture: New Zealand has a vibrant arts and culture scene. Many people enjoy attending art exhibitions, live theater performances, music concerts, and cultural festivals. Wellington and Auckland, in particular, have a strong arts and music scene



Wellington



NZ Green Lipped Mussels

Dining Out: Kiwis love good food, and dining out at restaurants and cafes is a popular way to socialize and enjoy the diverse culinary offerings in New Zealand. New Zealand's wine and craft beer industry is also thriving, and many people enjoy tasting local beverages.

Sports: Sports play a significant role in New Zealand culture. Rugby, cricket, and netball are particularly popular, and you'll often find Kiwis participating in or watching these sports. Other outdoor sports like soccer, golf, and tennis are also enjoyed.



The All Blacks performing the Haka

Commonly used Māori phrases

These phrases can help you get started with basic communication in Te Reo Māori and show respect for Māori culture and language

Here are 20 common phrases in Te Reo Māori:

- Kia ora - Hello / Hi
- Haere mai - Welcome
- Whānau - Family
- Ka kite anō - See you later
- E noho rā - Goodbye (informal)
- Tēnā koe - Thank you
- Kei te pehea koe? - How are you?
- Kia pai te rā - Have a good day
- Aroha - Love
- Kia kaha - Stay strong / Be strong
- Mauri ora - Good health / Vitality
- Haere rā - Goodbye (formal)
- E hika - Oh dear / Alas
- Ka pai - Well done / Good job
- Whakapapa - Genealogy / Ancestry
- Nau mai - Come in / Welcome
- E whiti ana te ra - The sun is shining
- Kia whakatōmuri te haere whakamua - Learn from the past to move forward
- Kaiako - Teacher
- Karawhiua! - Go for it! / Give it your best!

Māori pronunciation

Māori pronunciation can be quite different from English, and it's important to emphasize proper pronunciation when speaking Te Reo Māori. Here are some basic pronunciation guidelines:

Vowels:

A is pronounced like "ah" in "car."

E is pronounced like "eh" in "met."

I is pronounced like "ee" in "see."

O is pronounced like "oh" in "go."

U is pronounced like "oo" in "food."

Consonants:

H is pronounced more forcefully than in English. It's similar to the "h" sound in "hello."

K is pronounced like "k" in "king."

M is pronounced as in English.

N is pronounced as in English.

P is pronounced like "p" in "pen."

R is pronounced as a rolled or flapped "r," similar to the Spanish "rr."

T is pronounced like "t" in "top," but it can be pronounced with a glottal stop, especially at the end of words.

Diphthongs:

Māori has a few diphthongs, like ai and ae, which should be pronounced together, blending the vowel sounds.

Wh Sound:

The wh combination is pronounced as an "f" sound, like "whale" in English.

Macrons:

Some words in Te Reo Māori use macrons (long vowel marks) to indicate extended vowel sounds. For example, "ā" is pronounced longer than "a."

Stress and Length:

Māori pronunciation often emphasizes stress and length. Some words might have stress on the first syllable.

Emergency services

Emergency services in New Zealand can be reached by dialling 111 for immediate assistance in case of an emergency. Here's a list of key emergency services, along with their contact details:

Police (Emergency):

Phone: 111

Website: <https://www.police.govt.nz/>

Fire and Emergency New Zealand (Emergency):

Phone: 111

Website: <https://fireandemergency.nz/>

Ambulance and Medical Emergencies (St John New Zealand):

Phone: 111

Website: <https://www.stjohn.org.nz/>

Search and Rescue (NZSAR):

For non-emergency health advice, you can call Healthline at 0800 611 116.

Mental Health Crisis Helplines:

Lifeline (24/7 crisis support): 0800 543 354

Mental Health Crisis Helpline: 0800 111 757

Women's Refuge (Domestic Violence):

National Crisis Line: 0800 REFUGE (0800 733 843)

Website: <http://www.womensrefuge.org.nz/>

Youthline (Youth Support):

Phone: 0800 376 633

Website: <https://www.youthline.co.nz/>

Child, Youth, and Family Services (Oranga Tamariki):

Website: <https://www.orangatamariki.govt.nz/>

Roadside Assistance (The AA - Automobile Association):

- Phone: 0800 500 222
- Website: <https://www.aa.co.nz/>